Edutechlife



MODULE 2 · CHATGPT

The Complete ChatGPT Guide

From blueprint to build: tools, Projects, GPTs and agents for working with judgment

Module 2
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ChatGPT is not a search engine or an encyclopedia. It is a collaborator that writes, analyzes and carries out tasks when you give it **context**, a **goal** and **review**. This guide gives you what you need to use it like a professional.

6
elements of a strong prompt

3
steps to verify before using

8
tools in the ecosystem

01 The ecosystem map

Each tool solves a different kind of work. Choosing the right one saves time and reduces errors.

Tool	What it is for	When to use it
Chat	Thinking, writing, summarizing and explaining	Almost always the starting point
Web search	Recent data with sources	Figures, prices, news, current rules
Data analysis	Processing CSV, Excel and tables; creating charts	When there are numbers to check
Image generation	Illustrations and visual pieces	Visual ideas; text inside images is written separately
Canvas	Editing a document or code side by side with the conversation	Long texts that change over time
Projects	Grouping instructions and files for one piece of work	When the same context keeps coming back
GPTs	Assistants with their own instructions and knowledge	Recurring tasks with the same rules
Agent	Multi-step tasks carried out under your supervision	Researching, comparing and building a deliverable

02 Choosing the right model

ChatGPT offers several models from the GPT-6 family. Their names, limits and availability **depend on your plan** and change often. What stays stable is the decision rule:

Fast model

Drafts, summaries, emails, ideas, translations and simple tasks.

Reasoning or more powerful model

Complex analysis, decisions with several factors, long documents and logic-heavy work.

BEFORE YOU DECIDE

Open the model selector in your account: what you see depends on your plan. A more powerful model is not always better: it is slower and uses more resources. Use it when the task justifies it.

03 Prompts that work: the six elements

A strong prompt answers six questions. Not every one is needed every time, but the more you answer, the less the model has to guess.

Element	Question it answers	Example
Role	Who should answer?	You are a customer-care advisor at a language school in Manizales.
Context	What happened, and what do we know?	A student asked for a refund after a class was cancelled.
Task	What should it produce?	Write an empathetic email that explains the refund policy.
Format	What should it look like?	Three paragraphs, 150 words at most, no lists.
Constraints	What must it avoid?	Do not promise dates or amounts that are not in the policy.
Examples	What does a good result look like?	Include an example of a warm, professional tone.

A real comparison

WEAK

PROMPT

```
Write an email for customers.
```

STRONG

PROMPT

```
You are a customer-care advisor at a language school in Manizales.
Context: a student asked for a refund after a class was cancelled.
Task: write an empathetic email that explains the refund policy.
Format: three paragraphs, 150 words at most, no lists.
Constraints: do not promise dates or amounts that are not in the policy.
```

Iterate: ask for small changes ("shorten the second paragraph") instead of starting over, and compare versions before accepting one.

04 Web search and data analysis

Web search

Turn it on when you need recent information. Always ask for sources and open at least one before using a figure. If an answer cites no sources, treat it as a hypothesis.

Data analysis

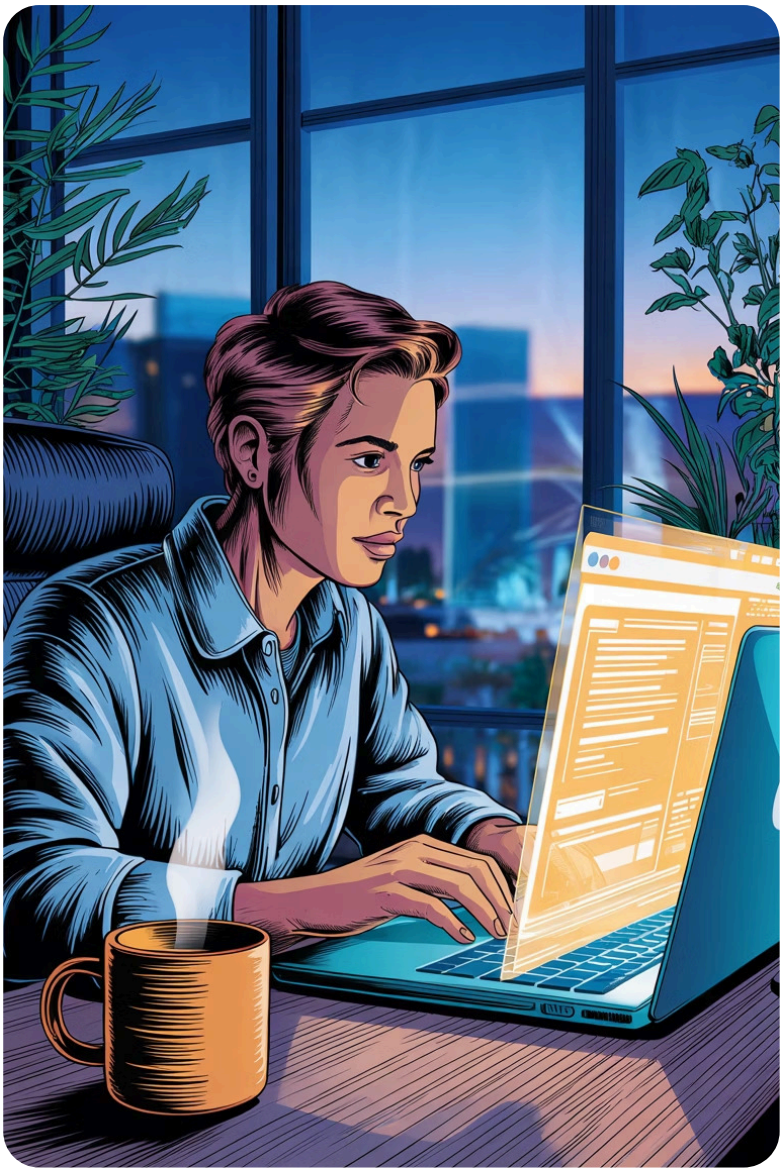
Upload your file (CSV or Excel), state the specific question and ask for the method. Check the result against a small sample, and ask for the steps or the code used.

GOOD QUESTION

What is the monthly change in enrollments between January and September? Show me the table, the method and a bar chart, and tell me if any months have missing data.

05 Projects: context that does not have to be repeated

A **Project** groups instructions and files for one piece of work. Every conversation inside the Project uses that context without you pasting it again.



One space for each piece of work, with its own context.

- [ ] Create one Project per topic, not one giant Project for everything.
- [ ] Write clear instructions: role, tone, limits and what must always be checked.
- [ ] Upload only the files you need, and review what each one contains.

06 Custom GPTs: assistants built for you

STATUS OF GPTS

OpenAI has announced it will retire custom GPTs on provisional dates: check in your account whether your GPT is still available, and consider moving its instructions to a Project.

A GPT combines three parts: **instructions** (role, tone and limits), **knowledge** (reference files) and, if you need them, **actions** (connections to other services).

BEFORE YOU SHARE A GPT

Decide who can use it and review which files it contains. Never load personal data about others, minors' data or confidential documents without authorization.

How to evaluate a GPT before sharing it

A GPT can look good in your first conversation and fail on a real case. Test it with these five cases before you share it.

Test	What the GPT should do
Normal case	Handles the task it was designed for
Edge case	Asks for the missing information before answering
Out of scope	Says clearly that it cannot help and suggests whom to ask
Sensitive data	Neither asks for nor repeats personal or minors' data
Consistency	Keeps the tone and rules through the whole conversation

07 The agent: multi-step tasks

The agent carries out a sequence of steps (searching, comparing, summarizing and building a deliverable). You stay in control: **you approve each step** before using the result.

1. Define the deliverable: what must exist at the end and in which format.
2. Set the limits: permitted sources, search scope and data it must not use.
3. Review the plan the agent proposes before it runs.
4. Verify every source and every figure in the final result.

08 Applications and connectors

ChatGPT can connect to external applications (for example travel, music, design or productivity tools). Each connection asks for permissions that you should read before you approve them.



Connections multiply what the assistant can do: so does the responsibility for each one.

- [ ] Connect only the applications you will actually use.
- [ ] Read the permissions each one asks for before approving them.
- [ ] Disconnect what you no longer use. Never give passwords in the chat.

09 Verify before you use

Models can be wrong with confidence. Verification is part of the work, not an optional step.

1. **Sources:** does every fact have a source you can open?
2. **Figures and names:** did you check them against the original?
3. **Sense:** does the result meet the goal and suit the audience?

GOLDEN RULE

If a figure, a quote or a rule matters for your decision, verify it in the original source before using it.

10 Personal data and minors

In Colombia, the processing of personal data is governed by **Law 1581 of 2012**. Minimize: share only what is necessary, anonymize before uploading, and never load minors' data, identity documents or third parties' financial information.

11 Worked example: a commercial proposal

Goal: prepare a three-page proposal for the principal's office of a school. Here is the full process in four steps.

1. **First prompt with the six elements:** role (education advisor), context (a school of 900 students in Manizales), task (a teacher training proposal on AI), format (three pages, with objective, a three-month plan and pricing), constraints (no guaranteed results).
2. **Review the first answer:** it shows what is missing. Here, the price has no assumptions and the tone is too sales-driven.
3. **Iterate one change at a time:** “Keep the structure. Change the tone to institutional and explain the price per student with its assumptions.”
4. **Verify before sending:** ask for sources for the market figures, open two of them and adjust anything you cannot confirm.

PROMPT

```
You are an education advisor. Context: a school of 900 students in Manizales
that wants to train its teachers in AI.
Task: write a three-page proposal with objective, a three-month plan and price
per student.
Format: clear headings and a schedule table.
Constraints: institutional tone; do not promise guaranteed results; mark every
market figure with [VERIFY].
```

12 Practice plan: five steps

1. Create a Project for a real piece of your own work and write its instructions.
2. Write a request with the six elements and compare it with a weak version.
3. Run a search with sources and verify two of them.

4 Analyze a small table and ask for the method and a chart.

5 Design a GPT with instructions, limits and a test with three real cases.

TO WRAP UP

- [ ] I chose the model for the task and checked the selector for my plan.
- [ ] My requests include goal, context, format and constraints.
- [ ] I verified sources and figures before using a result.
- [ ] I did not load personal or minors' data without authorization.